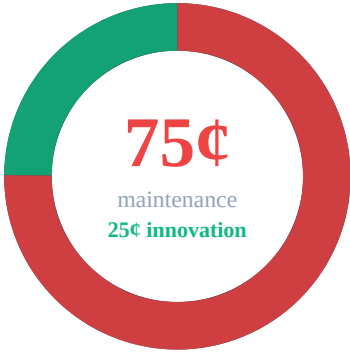
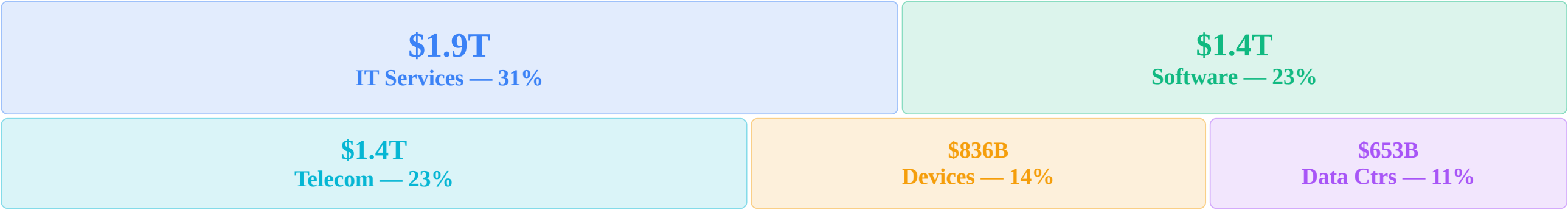


WHY NOW

The \$6.15 Trillion Question

Gartner · Deloitte · MIT Sloan · CNBC · Zylo · Flexera

\$6.15T Global IT Spending — 2026



-\$1T Software Market Cap

-\$285B Single-Day AI Wipeout

+1500% VMware License Hike

-58% PM SaaS

-42% IT Outsource

\$24B Short Profits

The \$6.15 Trillion Breakdown

Gartner's February 2026 forecast projects global IT spending at **\$6.15 trillion** — a 9.8% increase year-over-year. The number represents the largest technology investment in human history, distributed across IT services (\$1.9T), enterprise software (\$1.4T), telecom services (\$1.4T), devices (\$836B), and data center infrastructure (\$653B). Yet beneath this record spending, the actual return on investment is collapsing. Enterprises are buying more tools, more platforms, and more infrastructure than ever before — but getting less value from each dollar.

Why 75 Cents Buys Nothing New

The Deloitte CIO Survey reveals a devastating ratio: **75% of IT budgets** are consumed by operational maintenance. That's three-quarters of every dollar going to patching servers, renewing licenses, managing vendor contracts, servicing technical debt, and keeping legacy integrations from breaking. Only 25 cents funds anything new. Meanwhile, the average enterprise runs **660 SaaS applications**, most adopted without centralized oversight. Zylo's 2025 SaaS Management Index found **53% of licenses are completely unused**. That's not a rounding error — it's systemic waste at industrial scale.

The AI Readiness Crisis

AI isn't failing because the models are bad. **72% of CIOs** identify fragmented infrastructure as the #1 barrier to AI ROI (Gartner 2025). GPT-4, Claude, and Gemini perform brilliantly in isolation — but real enterprise deployment demands unified data, consistent APIs, and platform-wide observability. Instead, organizations have 660 disconnected tools, 3 competing cloud providers, and 14 different auth systems. The result: **95% of GenAI pilots** fail to deliver measurable business value (MIT Sloan 2025). Cloud waste adds insult: **27% of \$450B+** in global cloud spend is idle VMs and forgotten resources — ~\$17M/yr per org (Flexera).

Smart Money Exits Legacy

Wall Street's verdict is clear. **\$1 trillion** in software market cap was destroyed in Q1 2026 as investors concluded the old guard cannot deliver AI-ready infrastructure (CNBC). A single January trading day wiped **\$285 billion** from AI sector stocks (WinBuzzer). VMware's post-acquisition license restructuring hit customers with increases up to **+1,500%** (CIO/Avasant) — extraction, not innovation. PM SaaS **-58%** YTD, IT outsourcing **-42%**, CRM **-38%**. Hedge funds made **\$24 billion** shorting legacy vendors in five weeks. The message is unambiguous: fragmented infrastructure is a liability.